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Storage compartment or pocket for electronic devices

Abstract

Storage compartment or pocket having hydrophobic layers or removable hydrophobic material suitable for attachment to or placement between a garment for retaining and/or securing an electronic device and protecting or preventing the electronic device from contacting moisture and/or fluids.

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Background/Summary**TECHNICAL FIELD**

(1) The present disclosure relates to the field of garments and the field of electronic devices and storage means within the garment for retaining and protecting or preventing the electronic device from contacting moisture and/or fluids.

BACKGROUND

(2) Smart phones, portable media players and other electronic devices are preferably retained in a

storage compartment or pocket associated with a garment. Conventional garments with such storage means are both cumbersome and uncomfortable and it also makes it difficult to read the electronic device while engaged in an activity such as walking or running without risk of exposing the electronic device to condensation and/or bodily fluids. Providing storage means having complete waterproof protection eliminates the ability to allow the area around the electronic device that is otherwise in contact with the wearer to breathe and/or dry effectively resulting in discomfort and possible condensation within the storage means.

(3) In most garments, such as shorts, a waterproof liner (plastic fabric) is employed to keep the sweat off the electronic device and the electronic device is subject to exposure to an contact with perspiration. In addition, the waterproof liner, if it is either against the skin or even if it has a fabric layer between the skin and the waterproof pocket liner, causes the skin of the wearer in that area to get warmer and/or be discomforting. When the electronic device is in the pocket, the heat of the electronic device can also make the wearer even more warmer in that general vicinity. So it is a disadvantage for a wearer of a garment comprising such a pocket.

SUMMARY

(4) A principal object of this disclosure is to provide a storage compartment or pocket that will provide moisture vapor transmission, evaporative cooling, and protection of the electronic device from moisture and/or fluids to occur. This will provide more comfort with reduced heat stress, and potentially make longer cycles of wearing the garment with the electronic device possible.

(5) It is a further object to provide a breathable storage compartment or pocket for a garment that can be repeatedly used, e.g., washing and drying capability.

(6) In one embodiment, the present storage compartment or pocket that is a breathable laminate that comprises a hydrophobic spacer material adjacent to a stretchable hydrophobic material. The storage compartment or pocket laminate construction is suitable for attachment to a garment, such as shorts or a shirt. In one example, the storage compartment or pocket can be used in combination with an outer shell material comprising a wicking or non-wicking woven or nonwoven fabric.

(7) In other embodiments, the present disclosure is a breathable, semi-permeable, laminate that comprises hydrophobic spacer material layer having top and bottom surfaces; and at least one hydrophobic stretchable fabric layer attached to at least a portion of the perimeter of the hydrophobic spacer material layer so as to provide a storage compartment or pocket suitable for receiving an electronic device. Variations of this embodiment further include an outer shell textile layer.

(8) In other embodiments, a storage compartment or pocket for fastening to a garment is provided, the storage compartment or the pocket comprising: a garment fabric having a skin facing side and an opposed side; a hydrophobic spacer material adjacent the opposed side; and a stretchable hydrophobic material adjacent the hydrophobic spacer material forming a storage compartment or a pocket. In one example, the hydrophobic spacer material is secured, at least in part, to the opposed side. In another example, the hydrophobic spacer material is removable from the storage compartment or the pocket. In yet another example, alone or in combination with any of the previous examples, the storage compartment or the pocket further comprises an outer shell material comprising a wicking or non-wicking woven or nonwoven fabric.

(9) Aspects of the present disclosure include the articles described herein being storage compartment or pocket for a garment. Examples of such garments include shorts, bathing suits, athletic apparel, jerseys, etc. In one aspect, the storage compartment or pocket is configured for garments that are designed for a tight-fit or form-fit about the arm or leg of the wearer. In another aspect, the storage compartment or pocket is configured for garments that are designed for a tight-fit or form-fit about the arm or leg of the wearer so as to provide a self-sealing opening for the electronic device. In one aspect, the storage compartment or pocket is configured for garments that are designed for a tight-fit or form-fit about the arm or leg of the wearer and allow the use of wires or cable connectors to the electronic device.

(10) Other objects will be apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art when reviewing the instant specification, drawings, and claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWING

(1) In order that the disclosure be more readily understood, some embodiments thereof are described in the figures, summarized here, by way of example only.

(2) FIG. 1 is a side perspective view of the storage compartment or pocket in accordance with the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 2 is an exploded side view of the storage compartment or pocket in accordance with the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 3 is an exploded side view of the storage compartment or pocket with optional outer shell fabric in accordance with the present disclosure.

(5) FIG. 4 is a sectional side view of the storage compartment or pocket attached to the garment in accordance with the present disclosure.

(6) FIG. 5 is a sectional side view of the storage compartment or pocket with optional outer shell fabric in accordance with the present disclosure.

(7) FIG. 6 is a front view of the storage compartment or pocket in accordance with the present disclosure with sectional line A-A.

(8) FIG. 7 is a sectional top view of the storage compartment or pocket along sectional line A-A in accordance with the present disclosure.

(9) FIG. 8 is a sectional top view of an alternate configuration of the storage compartment or pocket along sectional line A-A in accordance with the present disclosure.

(10) FIGS. 9A, 9B, and 9C depict an exemplary assembly of the storage compartment or pocket in accordance with the present disclosure.

(11) FIG. 10 is an exploded side view of a storage compartment or pocket with optional outer shell fabric for receiving a removable spacer material in accordance with the present disclosure.

(12) FIG. 11 is a partial exploded view of the removable spacer material and stretch mesh fabric of the storage compartment or pocket in accordance with the present disclosure.

(13) FIG. 12A is a sectional side view of the storage compartment or pocket attached to the garment without the removable spacer material in accordance with the present disclosure.

(14) FIG. 12B is a sectional side view of the storage compartment or pocket attached to the garment with the removable spacer material in accordance with the present disclosure.

DETAIL DESCRIPTION

(15) As stated above, an object of the present disclosure is to provide a storage compartment or pocket that provides liquid protection for electronic devices as well as moisture vapor transmission and/or evaporative cooling to occur so as to provide improved comfort for the wearer.

(16) By using a hydrophobic spacer material as a laminate component, the storage compartment or pocket is configured so as to not uptake, absorb, draw, or contain perspiration and is provided advantageous separation of the electronic device from the skin of the wearer, allowing for air circulation. Such a configuration provides the wearer with improved comfort in allows the wearer to be cooler, as well as protects the electronic device from excess heat during normal or physical activity. In one aspect, the use of hydrophilic fabrics and/or materials is avoided in the construction of the storage device or pocket of the present disclosure.

(17) As used herein, these terms are defined as follows:

(18) “Laminate” as used herein is meant to exemplify a flexible article comprised of two or more flexible layers, resulting in a composite. Examples of laminates of the present disclosure can be comprised of a hydrophobic and/or non-wicking spacer material and

(19) “Seam” as used herein is meant to defined an area where two or more pieces or panels of the laminate are joined together by sewing, gluing, heat sealing, other mechanical joining procedures, and combinations thereof.

(20) “Breathable” as used herein is defined as the ability to transport moisture vapor (such as perspiration, for example) through a material. Breathable typically refers to materials having a Moisture Vapor Transmission Rate as measured by ASTM E96 and expressed in terms of g/m.sup.2/24 hr.

(21) “Breathability” as used herein refers to a property of a laminate or layer of the laminate that is measured in terms of moisture vapor transmission rate (MVTR), where higher values represent a more breathable material/laminate and lower values representing a less breathable material/laminate. MVTR generally refers to the rate at which water vapor permeates through a material as measured in units of grams per meter squared per 24 hours (g/m.sup.2/24 hr). Quantatively, breathability is defined herein MVTR rates of over 100 and up to about 7000 g/m.sup.2/24 hr.

(22) “Nonwoven web” or “nonwoven” refers to a web having a structure of individual threads (e.g., fibers or filaments) that are randomly interlaid, not in an identifiable manner as in a knitted storage compartment or pocket. Nonwoven webs include, for example, meltblown webs, spunbond webs, carded webs, wet-laid webs, airlaid webs, coform webs, hydraulically entangled webs, etc.

(23) “Semi-permeable” or “semi-permeability”, as used herein, means that the layer/laminate would significantly inhibit the flow of liquid or vapor from one side of the layer to the other side of the layer/laminate. Semi-permeable does not mean that the layer/laminate is impermeable to all vapors; for example, it may be permeable to water vapor but not organic solvents.

(24) Hydrophobic and/or Non-Wicking Spacer Material

(25) In one example, suitable materials for the hydrophobic spacer material are multi-zone lining systems such as DRI-LEX® which can be used alone or in combination with other materials such as GORE-TEX®. Non-limiting examples of suitable hydrophobic spacer materials are AEROSPACER® (Faytex Corp., Weymouth, Mass.), and PERSPAIR (Lenzi Egisto S.p.A, Vaiano, IT). Other multi-zone lining systems may be used or just the inner hydrophobic fiber part of such multi-zone lining systems may be used alone without fabric on opposing sides thereof. In one example, the hydrophobic spacer material is essentially non-wicking as to water. In another example, the hydrophobic spacer material is completely non-wicking as to water.

(26) By way of example DRI-LEX® provides excellent moisture movement properties as well as outstanding abrasion resistance, hand-feel, and attractive patterns and textures. While not being held to any particular theory, the present disclosure provides a storage compartment or pocket whereby perspiration is moved away from the skin surface by heat and mass transfer and into the hydrophobic spacer material of the storage compartment or pocket. The hydrophobic spacer material then works in conjunction with the hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric to re-distribute moisture. In one example, the hydrophobic spacer material comprises DRI-LEX® Diffusion fabric. Hydrophobic Stretch Mesh Fabric

(27) In one example, the hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric is a two-way stretch fabric. In another example, the hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric is a four-way stretch fabric. Suitable examples of hydrophobic stretch mesh fabrics include but are not limited to SPANDEX, ELASTANE (LYCRA) and includes polyester-spandex blends, stretch satin, stretch velvet, nylon-spandex, Rayon knit-spandex, rubber-latex, and neoprene rubber. In one example, the hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric is comprised of essentially all hydrophobic fiber. In another example, the hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric is comprised completely of hydrophobic fiber. Suitable fabrics may be knitted, such as Jersey knit, or other knit patterns that provide for 2-way or 4-way stretching or elastomeric recovery.

(28) The thickness of this layer can vary, and includes thicknesses ranging from about 0.5 to about 2.5 mils.

(29) This layer of the laminate can be breathable and liquid impermeable. In one example, the

hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric is a microporous and blocks the denser liquid molecules while allowing water vapor molecules to move through a series of microscopic voids in the fabric structure.

(30) Microporous fabrics include polyolefins. Representative olefinic polymers (polyolefins) include high and low basis weight polyethylene, polypropylene, polyvinyl containing polymers, butadiene containing polymers and the like. Condensation polymers include polyesters such as polyethylene terephthalate and polybutylene terephthalate, polyamides such as nylon 6, nylon 13 and nylon 66, polycarbonates and polysulfones. Polyphenylene oxide is representative of the oxidation polymers which can be used. Blends of thermoplastic polymers may also be used in connection with this embodiment and others. While most of these thermoplastic polymers can be utilized in forming a suitable web for combining with microporous film, the microporous film can be comprised of polymeric materials, i.e. thermoplastics, which can survive sewing, adhesive bonding, ultrasonic point bonding and the like without losing the properties and maintaining moisture vapor permeability.

Optional Outer Shell

(31) A woven or nonwoven outer shell (or outer shell textile layer) may be fastened to the portion of the garment adjacent the storage compartment or pocket. The outer shell textile layer may be woven, knit, or nonwoven. A nonwoven textile layer may be chosen if the product is to be considered limited use or disposable, whereas a woven fabric may be chosen if of the product is to be considered reusable. As used herein, the term "nonwoven" means a web having a structure of individual fibers or threads which are interlaid, but not in an identifiable manner as in a knitted storage compartment or pocket. Nonwoven storage compartment or pockets or webs have been formed from various processes such as, for example, meltblowing processes, spunbonding processes, and bonded carded web processes.

(32) As one of ordinary skill in the art would appreciate, there are many on the market nonwoven products, such as polyester or polypropylene blends that may be used in conjunction with this layer. That is, as indicated above, the outer shell textile layer may be any desired textile, including woven, knitted and nonwoven materials and composites of such materials. The textile may be selected based on the properties required for a given application, exercising, particular sports, comfort, weight, and moisture vapor transmissivity. Suitable textiles include NOMEX, available from Southern Mills, N.Y. or nylon. Other suitable textiles include nonwovens such as SPANDEX, or VILENE nonwoven, commercially available from Freudenberg, and E89 nonwoven, commercially available from DuPont. The textile layer generally may have many variations in terms of thickness.

(33) The outer shell textile layer generally does not contribute significantly to the receiving, securing, and protecting of the electronic device offered by the storage compartment or pocket laminate, nor does it significantly negatively affect the receiving, securing, and protecting of the electronic device provided by the laminate. The outer shell textile layer can offer additional physical protection against abrasion tear and puncture of the storage compartment or pocket.

Fastening

(34) A variety of techniques, methods, and processes may be used to pass the layers of the storage compartment or pocket laminate one to the other. In one example, conventional stitching techniques are used alone or in combination with other bonding, fusing, or melting techniques.

(35) In certain embodiments of the present disclosure, an adhesive may be used to fasten the layers of the storage compartment or pocket laminate. The adhesive and/or adhesive process may be forming a continuous adhesive layer or maybe discontinuous such as a spaced apart pattern applied using the gravure process or applied as random filaments of adhesive.

(36) Alternatively, the layers may be thermally fused or pressure laminated, without any intervening adhesive. The process parameters for this operation will vary depending on the materials used for the components of the laminate and the garment fabric used, and would be

selected to provide good adhesion without significant damage or deterioration of any of the layers or the garment.

(37) Yet another significant variation of the present disclosure would be a breathable storage compartment or pocket that would also be readily machine washable.

(38) Articles comprising the storage compartment or may be configured into a variety of configurations that take advantage of the unique properties of the present disclosure. Traditional fastening techniques apparent to those of skill in the art may be used to assemble laminate panels into desired configurations.

(39) With reference to FIG. 1 a perspective view of an exemplary storage compartment or pocket **500** is shown attached to an exemplary garment **50**. Pocket **500** is configured so as to receive and accommodate electronic device **75**. As shown, pocket **500** has finished top **450** of hydrophobic stretch fabric **400** that is shown as stitched to garment **50** with stitching **425** about the sides and bottom of pocket **500**. In one example, finished top **450** is constructed of a turned back hem with cover stitch that provides four-way stretch to the finished top for facilitating receiving and removing electronic device **75**.

(40) With reference to FIG. 2 an exploded side view of the storage compartment or pocket **500** in accordance with the present disclosure is shown comprising hydrophobic spacer material **300** in closest proximity to skin surface **100** attached to hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** and furthest proximity from skin surface **100**. As shown, attachment is by stitching **425**. Hydrophobic spacer material **300** as finished top **375** which may be sown or bonded or otherwise attached to provide for receipt of electronic device. Hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** also has finished top **450** which may be stitched or bonded so as to prevent mesh fabric from unraveling. Stitches **425** provide means for attaching storage compartment or pocket **500** to portion of garment fabric **200**. As shown, stitches **425** are absent adjacent to finished top **375** of spacer material and finished top **450** sown to hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** as to provide an opening for receiving electronic device **75**. By virtue of the fact that hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** is configured to stretch in at least 2 directions, or in at least 4 directions, fabric **400** will provide securement of electronic device **75** in combination with hydrophobic spacer material **300**. Hydrophobic spacer material **300** in one aspect has elasticity less than that of stretch mesh fabric **400**. Hydrophobic spacer material **300** in one aspect as resiliency of at least 2× that of wool, at least 5× that of wool, or at least 10× that of wool. The resiliency of hydrophobic spacer material **300** in combination with hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** provides for containment of the electronic device during wearing of the garment by a user.

(41) The thickness of hydrophobic spacer material **300** can be about 0.5 to about 2.5 mils. The thickness of the hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** can be about 0.5 to about 2.5 mils.

(42) With reference to FIG. 3, an exploded side view of the storage compartment or pocket **500** is shown with optional outer shell fabric **600** where outer shell fabric **600** may contain elastomeric banding **625** corresponding to elastomeric banding **225** of the portion of garment fabric **200**. In one aspect elastomeric banding **625** and elastomeric banding **225** are fastened to garment fabric **200**.

(43) With reference to FIG. 4, a sectional side view of the storage compartment or pocket **500** attached to the portion of garment **200** is shown where hydrophobic spacer material as skin-facing surface **305** and opposing surface **310** with hydrophobic fiber filaments **320** contain their between. Hydrophobic spacer material surfaces **305**, **310** may be of a microporous material and/or contain a honeycomb or other open pattern type design to permit airflow. Formation of the storage compartment or pocket is illustrated by the bonding of bottom edge **350** of hydrophobic spacer material with corresponding bottom edge **425** of stretch mesh fabric **400**.

(44) With reference to FIG. 5, a sectional side view of the storage compartment or pocket **500** with optional outer shell fabric **600** is shown with edge **625** bonded to portion of garment **200** in accordance with the present disclosure.

(45) With reference to FIG. 6 a front view of the storage compartment or pocket **500** is shown

attached to portion of garment fabric **200** exemplified by stitching **425**.

(46) FIG. 7 and FIG. 8 depict sectional top views of the storage compartment or pocket **500** along sectional line A-A showing alternate attachment configurations of the hydrophobic spacer material **300** and hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400**. In the configuration shown in FIG. 7, hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** wraps around at least one edge of hydrophobic spacer material **300** when fastened to portion of garment **200**. In the configuration shown in FIG. 8, edges of hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** align with edges of hydrophobic spacer material **300** when fastened to portion of garment **200**.

(47) FIGS. 9A, 9B, and 9C depict an exemplary assembly of the storage compartment or pocket laminate **500** in accordance with the present disclosure, where they suitably sized portion of hydrophobic spacer material **300** is provided and finished top **375** is formed as a portion of the laminate. This portion of the laminate is attached to hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** sized accordingly and provided with finished top **450**. These two plies of the laminate can be: (a) fastened together on three sides and then fastened to portion of garment **200** (not shown) so as to form a storage compartment or pocket for receiving an electronic device; or (b) fastened together on three sides while fastening to the portion of garment **200**.

(48) As an alternative means of fastening, hydrophobic spacer material **300** and hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** may be adhesively laminated, or ultrasonic or laser welded either together and/or together with the portion of garment **200**. Hydrophobic spacer material **300** provides resiliency and moisture repellency and as a soft textile characteristic feel. Hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** provides for close fit and securement of electronic device and in addition provides further reduction from liquids on either the interior or exterior surface thereof. In one aspect, the portion of garment **200** is of a stretchable material similar to or the same as that of hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400**.

(49) As stated herein, the laminates of the present disclosure can be readily fastened to many different articles. Non-limiting examples include running shorts, tennis shorts, basketball shorts, sleeves, sweatshirts, and other garments.

(50) These articles can include pieces of laminates joined together. In other aspects, a portion of the hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** of the storage compartment or pocket **500** can be configured with a transparent material or film suitable for operably interacting with touchscreens of various electronic devices so long as the size and shape of the transparent material or film does not negatively impact the ability of the storage compartment or pocket **500** from receiving and/or securing the electronic device.

(51) Liquid proofing the stitching about the storage compartment or pocket **500** can further be envisioned. One example is by first sewing the non-removable hydrophobic spacer material **300** and hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** together using conventional sewing techniques. Liquid-proof sealing of these sewn seams can then be accomplished by the application of a seam tape or bonding treatment as is known in the art. The seal seam may have a thermoplastic hot melt adhesive which seals to the surface of the laminate and creates a seal over the stitches for improved comfort and to avoid unraveling of the stitches.

(52) In one example, hydrophobic spacer material **300** is provided as a removable hydrophobic spacer material **307**. Thus, removable hydrophobic spacer material **307** is not stitched or threaded at bottom edge **350**, but rather, has parallel lateral side edges **376** and parallel lateral top and bottom edges **375** and **377**, respectively. In one example, removable hydrophobic spacer material **307** is sown on all four sides. In another example, removable hydrophobic spacer material **307** is sown on all four sides using a turned back hem with cover stitch comprising a non-stretching thread so as to reduce or eliminate exposure of the raw edges of the spacer material.

(53) Thus, with reference to FIGS. 10-12B, a sectional side view of a storage compartment or pocket **500** (without removable spacer material **307**) with optional outer shell fabric **600** is shown with edge **625** of outer shell fabric **600** bonded to portion of garment **200** and bottom edge **425** of

hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** bonded directly to garment fabric **200** forming a pocket for receiving a removable spacer material **307**. Outer shell **600** is shown with opening **650** for charge port or speaker cord.

(54) With reference to FIG. **11**, removable spacer material **307** shown in a partially exploded view with hydrophobic stretch fabric **400**. Removable spacer material **307** has a length (L1) and width (W1) smaller than corresponding length (L2) and width (W2) of hydrophobic stretch fabric **400** as shown by dotted reference lines R1 and R2, such that when the pocket **500** is formed by attachment of hydrophobic stretch fabric **400** to garment **200**, the removal spacer material **307** can be removably engaged with the pocket **500**. In one example, the removable spacer material **307** is about 80% to 95% of the size of pocket **500**. The removable spacer material **307** is designed to be lightweight, having a substantially open structure substantially throughout, and can be configured for one-time use, or machine washable for multiple uses.

(55) In one example, hydrophobic stretch fabric **400** is attached to garment **200** with water resistant or waterproof thread **425**. Hydrophobic stretch fabric **400** is sewn or stitched about the two longitudinal sides and one bottom side thereof, so as to form an opening for receiving the removable spacer material **307** and/or the electronic device. In one example, finished top **450** is fabricated with a turned back hem with cover stitch for improved comfort.

(56) With reference to FIGS. **12A** and **12B**, a sectional side view of the storage compartment or pocket **500** attached to the portion of garment **200** with optional outer shell fabric **600** is shown without the removable hydrophobic spacer material **307** and the with removable hydrophobic spacer material **307** positioned in the pocket **500** formed by the hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** bonded to garment **200**, respectively. In one example, hydrophobic spacer material **307** comprises skin-facing surface **305** and opposing surface **310** (not shown) of a microporous material and/or contains a honeycomb or other open pattern type design with hydrophobic fiber filaments **320** (not shown) contained there between to permit airflow, as described above. The removable hydrophobic spacer material **307** is configured for positioning between garment fabric **200** and electronic device **75** (not shown). In one example, at least a portion of edges **376** or **375** contain fastening means, such as VELCRO™ or other means to impart friction, or resistance of movement, of the hydrophobic spacer material **307** from the garment fabric **200** when inserted into pocket **500**.

(57) Removable hydrophobic spacer material **307** in one example is configured for positioning a distance (D) from the elastomeric banding **625** of garment **200**. In one example, D is 1 cm, 2 cm, or 3 cm. By virtue of the fact that hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** is configured to stretch in at least 2 directions, or in at least 4 directions, fabric **400** will provide securement of electronic device **75** in combination with removable hydrophobic spacer material **307**. Removable hydrophobic spacer material **307** in one aspect has elasticity less than that of stretch mesh fabric **400**.

Removable hydrophobic spacer material **307** in one aspect as resiliency of at least 2× that of wool, at least 5× that of wool, or at least 10× that of wool. The resiliency of removable hydrophobic spacer material **307** in combination with hydrophobic stretch mesh fabric **400** provides for containment of the electronic device during wearing of the garment by a user.

(58) Unless otherwise indicated, all numbers expressing quantities, amounts, sizes, and properties such as reaction conditions, and so forth used in the Specification and exemplary claims are to be understood as being modified in all instances by the term “about.” Accordingly, unless indicated to the contrary, the numerical parameters set forth in the Specification and Claims are approximations that may vary depending upon the desired properties sought to be determined by the present disclosure.

(59) Notwithstanding that the numerical ranges and parameters setting forth the broad scope of the disclosure are approximations, the numerical values set forth are reported as precisely as possible. Any numerical value, however, inherently contain certain errors necessarily resulting from the standard deviation found in their respective testing measurements.

Claims

1. A storage compartment or pocket comprising: a breathable laminate comprising: hydrophobic stretch fabric secured, at least in part, at three sides to an exterior of a garment so as to form an opening configured to receive an electronic device, the storage compartment or pocket having a length and a width; wherein the garment is a shirt, shorts, pants, or a jacket; and an outer shell material comprising a wicking or non-wicking woven or nonwoven fabric adhered to the garment; and a removable hydrophobic spacer material, having a length and a width sized so as to be received and removed from the storage compartment or the pocket; wherein the removable hydrophobic spacer material has top and bottom surfaces and is sewn or hemmed on all four sides thereof, wherein the hydrophobic spacer is configured to be positioned between the garment and an electronic device wherein the outer shell material reversibly covers the opening.
 2. A storage compartment or pocket for an electronic device, comprising: a garment fabric having a skin facing side and an opposed side; a removable hydrophobic spacer material adjacent the opposed side; and a hydrophobic stretch fabric adjacent the hydrophobic spacer material, wherein the hydrophobic stretch fabric is secured, at least in part, at three sides to the opposed side of the garment fabric so as to form an opening in the storage compartment or the pocket; wherein the removable hydrophobic spacer material is 80-95% of the size of the opening so as to be reversibly received and removed from the storage compartment or the pocket; wherein the removable hydrophobic spacer material having a top surface and a bottom surface sewn or hemmed on all four sides thereof, wherein the hydrophobic spacer is configured to be positioned between the garment and an electronic device.
 3. The storage compartment or pocket of claim 2, further comprising an outer shell material comprising a wicking or non-wicking woven or nonwoven fabric.
 4. A garment comprising: a skin facing side; an opposed side; a hydrophobic stretch fabric engaged at three sides to the opposed side of the garment defining an opening; a removable hydrophobic spacer configured to be positioned between the hydrophobic stretch fabric and the garment; the removable hydrophobic spacer material having a size 80-95% less than the opening so as to be reversibly received and removed from the opening, the removable hydrophobic spacer material being sewn or hemmed on all four sides thereof.
 5. The garment of claim 4, further comprising an outer shell material comprising a wicking or non-wicking woven or non-woven material.
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